

- Many developments in the OSS world occur very fast, almost at the same time. It is hard to keep track of which one is the latest version of a particular software.
- In most cases, there is no proper support service for installation, configuration or troubleshooting.
- There is also the risk of open source software stagnating, due to developer distraction or the loss of motivation and resources.

Q What are the problems impeding the widespread adoption of open source technologies?

As we see it, even though open source comes with cost and scalability advantages, the adoption level is low. Awareness and support are two key issues which have to be tackled. It is easy to download software for free, but that requires support in terms of seamless installation and implementation. We should, therefore, provide support to enterprises, right from product selection and installation configuration to maintenance (all on one platform), thereby accelerating the adoption of open source technology.

Q What measures do you think should be taken to drive up the adoption rate of open source?

First, open source adoption has to be a part of an organisation's and CIO's IT strategy. Second, one has to select the right set of resources. The companies have to work towards creating an end-to-end solution comprising product selection, and support for installation and maintenance. It

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channel with Padfone 2. Due to the innovative design of the Padfone, the product cycle is a little bit longer. Also, people need time to understand the two-in-one feature of the Padfone device. This is the main reason for the delay in the launch of Padfone 2 in India.

Q Asus is looking forward to launching the low-end MemoPad 7 tablet in India. Do you think there is enough scope in the low-end tablet market in India?

Primarily, what we have seen from the other players in the low-end Indian tablet market is that there is actually huge potential. The local tablet brands have helped us by introducing tablets to Indians beforehand. We believe that the local brands have initiated the trend and have also developed the initial demand in the Indian market. After the initial market is created, people would want to have better products. The tablet market will keep on growing from here, and we believe there is enough potential for Asus. Where notebooks took around a decade to develop the market, tablets will take just three years.

Q What kind of response have you observed in India with respect to tablet PCs?

In India, last year saw the tablet business start off. We believe around 2 million tablet units were sold in India in 2012. This year, we can expect the sales to increase greatly,

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Q What has the Indian community's response been to accepting open source technologies and software?

The open source community in India is one of the largest in the world. As the market is maturing, organisations in India have slowly started accepting the advantages of open source platforms and encouraging collaboration. Open standards is a key facilitator for customisation and innovation, and the Indian developer community is creating OSS for a wide range of applications. With the increasing adoption of business applications by the Indian small and medium businesses, and cost being a key constraint in the adoption of applications development tools, open source solutions offer an interesting alternative. Government institutions and PSUs are in discussions regarding the adoption of open source software, e.g., the Indian Railways is supporting the deployment of Asterisk, an open source telephony platform, for all new developments in internal telephone services. 

as big brands are slowly entering the market. Previously, tablets were sold in the mobile shops. In 2013, the IT channel will also rush to get tablets.

Q Recently, Acer launched its Iconia B1 tablet under the sub-10K category. What are the key challenges for Asus in launching a tablet in the low-end market?

Our team at Asus is trying to figure out the major challenges related to budget devices in the Indian market. Meanwhile, we are observing the experience of other brands. Also, we don't want to compromise on the product's features and the quality. So, having a product with a good design and features, while at the same time keeping the price low, is a major challenge for Asus. We are reviewing all the possibilities of launching a good product at a decent price.

Q How is Asus planning to market its upcoming Android-based devices in the Indian market?

The mobile device segment has changed its course, and is more like a convergence of the tablet and the smartphone. So, it's hard to predict what the end users will want in their devices. At Asus, we try to focus on the entire product line up. We are trying to bring the best out of the innovations in the tablet market, and hope that people will like the quality being offered to them from a brand. 